School of Innovation and Management (SoIM)

Post Graduate Diploma in Management (PGDM)

Course Outline | **PGDM (2025-27)** | **Trimester – IV**

Course Code: 403GN	Course Name: Business Strategy	Course Credits: 03

Faculty: Dr. Samala Nagaraj
Email.ID: samala.nagaraj@soim.edu.in

Course Coverage:

Designed specifically for 4th-trimester PGDM specialization students, Business Strategy is an advanced capstone elective that integrates functional disciplines (Marketing, Finance, Operations, HR) into a cohesive general management perspective. Moving beyond introductory frameworks, this course focuses on competitive advantage, corporate architecture, platform economics, disruptive innovation, and strategic execution in hyper-competitive, volatile global markets.

Students will investigate how visionary leaders formulate and execute corporate-level and business-level strategies, manage multi-business portfolios, orchestrate strategic alliances and M&A, navigate geopolitical shifts, and lead organizational transformation in the era of artificial intelligence and platform capitalism. Through rigorous case method analyses, strategic simulations, and live industry strategy projects, students develop the diagnostic and executive capabilities required of C-suite leaders and management consultants.

Course Objectives:

1. To critically examine the theoretical foundations of competitive advantage, resource-based views (RBV), dynamic capabilities, and strategic intent in fast-moving industries.
2. To master advanced frameworks of industry analysis, competitive dynamics, game theory, platform business models, and ecosystem orchestration.
3. To evaluate corporate-level strategy decisions, including vertical integration, diversification, global expansion, mergers & acquisitions (M&A), and alliance portfolios.
4. To analyze the intricacies of strategic execution, organizational design, corporate governance, and leading large-scale digital and cultural transformations.
5. To formulate and defend a comprehensive strategic turnaround or growth blueprint for an incumbent enterprise facing digital disruption through an applied capstone project.

Course Learning Outcomes:

After completing the course, student should be able to: Five points for 1.5 Credit Course and Ten points for 3 Credit course

1. Diagnose industry structural attractiveness and anticipate competitor moves using game-theoretic and dynamic strategy frameworks. (Aligned with PLO1 & PLO6)
2. Evaluate firm-specific resources and dynamic capabilities to construct sustainable competitive advantages. (Aligned with PLO1)

3. Design business-level competitive strategies (cost leadership, differentiation, blue ocean strategy) tailored to specific industry lifecycles. (Aligned with PLO2 & PLO5)

4. Analyze corporate diversification strategies, vertical integration boundaries, and international expansion trade-offs. (Aligned with PLO1 & PLO6)

5. Structure and evaluate corporate mergers, acquisitions, and strategic alliance partnerships for value creation. (Aligned with PLO3)

6. Formulate platform business strategies, network effect models, and multi-sided market monetization structures. (Aligned with PLO2 & PLO3)

7. Appraise strategic responses to digital disruption, artificial intelligence adoption, and disruptive innovation threats. (Aligned with PLO3 & PLO6)

8. Lead cross-functional strategy formulation teams, demonstrating executive communication and persuasive negotiation skills. (Aligned with PLO4)

9. Access and synthesize cutting-edge global business cases, strategic management journals, and open-access strategy repositories. (Aligned with PLO4)

10. Present professional corporate strategy recommendations and board-level deck presentations solving complex business challenges. (Aligned with PLO4 & PLO6)

Assessment Tools for Learning Outcome:

Learning Outcome	Assessment Criteria
Diagnose industry structure and competitor dynamics.	Mid-Term Test, Industry Analysis Assignment, Class Participation
Evaluate firm resources and dynamic capabilities.	Resource Audit Case Report, Mid-Term Test
Design business-level competitive strategies and Blue Oceans.	Blue Ocean Strategy Assignment, Group Presentation
Analyze corporate diversification and international expansion.	Corporate Strategy Case Analysis, Final Exam
Structure mergers, acquisitions, and alliance partnerships.	M&A Valuation & Integration Case Report, Final Exam
Formulate platform business models and network effects.	Platform Strategy Project, Class Presentation
Appraise strategic responses to digital and AI disruption.	Disruptive Innovation Paper Review, Seminar Discussion
Lead cross-functional strategy teams and negotiations.	Strategy Simulation Game Performance, Peer Evaluations
Access and synthesize global business cases and literature.	Literature Review & Case Briefs, Class Discussions

Present board-level strategic recommendations.	Capstone Executive Strategy Deck & Defense Presentation

Pedagogy:

The course will be covered across 20 sessions of 90 minutes each, totaling 30 hours for this 3-credit advanced specialization course. The pedagogy emphasizes the Harvard Case Method, competitive business strategy simulations (e.g., Global Strategy Simulation), executive masterclasses, structured debates on strategic dilemmas, and a comprehensive capstone corporate turnaround project.

Session Plan:

Session Plan: 20 sessions of 90 minutes each, totaling 30 Hours for 3 Credit course.

S. No.	Topic	Pre-reading / Reference	Pedagogy
1	The Architecture of Competitive Advantage • What is Strategy? Evolution from planning to positioning and dynamic capabilities • Sustainable competitive advantage in hyper-competitive environments	Porter, 'What is Strategy?' (HBR); Rumelt, 'Good Strategy/Bad Strategy' - Chapter 1	Lecture & Strategic Discussion
2	Industry Analysis & Competitive Dynamics • Beyond Five Forces: Game theory, strategic moves, and commitment • Ecosystem analysis and boundary blurring	Porter, 'The Five Competitive Forces That Shape Strategy' (HBR); Brandenburger & Nalebuff, 'Co-opetition'	Interactive Case Analysis
3	Resource-Based View (RBV) & Dynamic Capabilities • VRIO framework: Valuing tangible and intangible organizational assets • Dynamic capabilities and organizational agility	Barney, 'Firm Resources and Sustained Competitive Advantage'; Teece et al., 'Dynamic Capabilities'	Lecture & RBV Exercise
4	Business-Level Strategy: Cost, Differentiation & Blue Oceans • Generic strategies revisited: Stuck in the middle trap • Blue Ocean Strategy: Value innovation and eliminating trade-offs	Porter, Competitive Strategy Chapters; Chan Kim & Mauborgne, 'Blue Ocean Strategy'	Case Study: Ryanair / Southwest
5	Disruptive Innovation & Technological Discontinuity • Innovator's Dilemma: Why great companies fail when facing new tech	Christensen, 'The Innovator's Dilemma' (Summary/Excerpt); HBR:	Lecture & Tech Strategy Case

	• Managing sustaining vs. disruptive innovations	'How to Identify Disruptive Threats'	
6	Platform Strategy & Multi-Sided Business Models • Pipeline vs. Platform businesses: Direct and indirect network effects • Monetization and governance in platform ecosystems	Parker, Van Alstyne, & Choudary, 'Platform Revolution' - Chapters 1 & 2; HBR: 'Pipelines, Platforms, and the New Rules of Strategy'	Case Study: Apple vs. Android Ecosystems
7	Corporate Strategy: Vertical Integration & Scope • Transaction Cost Economics (TCE): Make-or-buy decisions • Scope of the firm: Economies of scope and core competencies	Prahalad & Hamel, 'The Core Competence of the Corporation' (HBR); Williamson, TCE framework	Lecture & Integration Exercise
8	Corporate Diversification & Portfolio Management • Related vs. unrelated diversification and value creation • BCG Growth-Share Matrix, GE/McKinsey Matrix, and corporate parenting advantage	Goold, Campbell, & Alexander, 'Corporate Strategy: The Quest for Parent Advantage'	Case Analysis & Portfolio Mapping
9	Mergers, Acquisitions (M&A) & Alliance Strategies • M&A wave dynamics, pre-due diligence traps, and post-merger integration (PMI) • Strategic alliances, joint ventures, and ecosystem partnerships	Christensen et al., 'The Big Idea: The New M&A Playbook' (HBR); Dyer et al., 'The Relational View'	Case Study: Disney & Pixar / Marvel M&A
10	Global Strategy: Competing Across Borders • Integration-Responsiveness framework: Multinational, global, international, and transnational strategies • Managing geopolitical risks and local adaptation	Ghemawat, 'Distance Still Matters' (HBR); Bartlett & Ghoshal, 'Managing Across Borders'	Lecture & International Case
MID-TERM EXAMINATION			
11	Digital Transformation & AI Strategy for Incumbents • Orchestrating enterprise-wide digital transformation	HBR: 'Digital at Scale' (Beane et al.); MIT Sloan Management Review: 'Competing in the Age of AI'	Masterclass & Discussion

	• AI-driven business models and data-monetization strategies		
12	Strategic Leadership & Corporate Governance • Role of the CEO, Board of Directors, and top management teams (TMT) • Agency theory, executive compensation, and ethical leadership	Jensen & Meckling, 'Theory of the Firm'; HBR: 'What Makes a Great Board?'	Case Study: Corporate Governance Failures
13	Strategy Execution & Balanced Scorecard • Bridging the gap between formulation and execution • Balanced Scorecard: Financial, customer, internal business, and learning/growth perspectives	Kaplan & Norton, 'Using the Balanced Scorecard as a Strategic Management System' (HBR)	Lecture & Strategy Execution Lab
14	Managing Strategic Change & Turnaround Strategies • Diagnosing corporate decline and executing turnaround maneuvers • Overcoming organizational inertia and cognitive barriers to change	Hambrick & Schecter, 'Turnaround Strategies for Mature Industrial Products'; HBR: 'Leading Change: Why Transformation Efforts Fail'	Case Analysis: Corporate Turnaround
15	Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR), ESG & Sustainability Strategy • Integrating ESG metrics into core business strategy • Creating Shared Value (CSV) and sustainable competitive advantage	Porter & Kramer, 'Creating Shared Value' (HBR); Freeman, 'Strategic Management: A Stakeholder Approach'	Seminar & ESG Case Study
16	Family Business & Entrepreneurial Strategy • Unique governance, succession, and strategic challenges in family enterprises • Ambidextrous strategies in entrepreneurial ventures	Habbershon & Williams, 'Resource-Based Framework for Family Business'; HBR: 'The Family Business Advantage'	Case Study & Discussion
17	Strategic Agility & Scenario Planning in Hyper-Uncertainty • Navigating black swan events and VUCA environments using scenario planning • Strategic agility and real options reasoning	Courtney et al., 'Strategy Under Uncertainty' (HBR); Schoemaker, 'Scenario Planning'	Workshop & Scenario Exercise

18	Venture Capital, Corporate Venturing & Ecosystems • Corporate Venture Capital (CVC) and incubators as strategic weapons • Scouting startups and managing corporate-startup partnerships	HBR: 'The Rise of Corporate Venturing'; Chesbrough, 'Open Innovation'	Guest Masterclass & Discussion
19	Capstone Strategy Presentations (Part 1) • Student group presentations of comprehensive corporate turnaround and growth strategy projects	Student Group Capstone Strategy Reports	Executive Presentations & Evaluation
20	Capstone Strategy Presentations (Part 2) & Course Synthesis • Final board-level defense presentations, faculty critique, and future frontiers of strategic management	Course Synthesis Notes & Strategic Frameworks	Presentations & Course Wrap-up
END-TERM EXAMINATION			

Recommended Text Book:

1. Grant, R. M. (10th Edition). Contemporary Strategy Analysis. John Wiley & Sons.

2. Porter, M. E. (1985). Competitive Advantage: Creating and Sustaining Superior Performance. Free Press.

3. Rothaermel, F. T. (6th Edition). Strategic Management. McGraw-Hill Education.

4. Hitt, M. A., Ireland, R. D., & Hoskisson, R. E. (13th Edition). Strategic Management: Competitiveness and Globalization. Cengage Learning.

5. Rumelt, R. P. (2011). Good Strategy/Bad Strategy: The Difference and Why It Matters. Crown Business.

Reference Text Books / Recourses (Journals, Internet Websites):

• Universally Accepted Textbooks: Barney, J. B., & Hesterly, W. S., 'Strategic Management and Competitive Advantage'; Kim, W. C., & Mauborgne, R., 'Blue Ocean Strategy'; Parker, G. G., Van Alstyne, M. W., & Choudary, S. P., 'Platform Revolution'.

• Harvard Business Review (HBR) Classic Articles: Michael E. Porter ('What is Strategy?', 'The Five Forces'); C.K. Prahalad & Gary Hamel ('The Core Competence of the Corporation'); Clayton M. Christensen ('How Will You Measure Your Life?'); W. Chan Kim & Renée Mauborgne ('Blue Ocean Strategy').

• Free Web Resources, Case Studies & MOOCs: Coursera / edX free audit tracks for 'Business Strategy' (Darden School of Business / Wharton School); MIT Sloan Management Review open articles on platform ecosystems and digital transformation; McKinsey Quarterly insights on corporate strategy and geopolitical risk; YouTube channels: Harvard Business Review, Stanford Graduate School of Business, and Wharton School.

Course Evaluation:

Evaluation is a continuous process at SoIM. Students will be given individual/group projects/ assignments in strategic analysis case reports, industry competitive audits, and capstone turnaround presentations. Keeping in line with continuous evaluation at SoIM, the evaluation scheme is as follows:

Areas	Weightage
(I) Continuous Evaluation: *(Quizzes: 10 Marks, Assignments, Group/Individual Projects: 30 Marks*	40%
(II) Mid Term Examination	20%
(III) Final Examination	40%
Total	**100 %**

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